AMD DEVELOPER HACKATHON ACT III · TRACK 4

VIRAL

One whisper. A whole town reacts.

A butterfly-effect game where eight AI residents — Gemma on AMD — turn one sentence into an evening nobody scripted.



THE PROBLEM

Stories either ignore your words or ignore consequences

Scripted stories

Branching trees are authored by hand: expensive, finite, and they only react to the choices the writer predicted.

Chatbot stories

Free text in, free text out — but nothing in the world changes, nothing is checked, and the story forgets what is true.

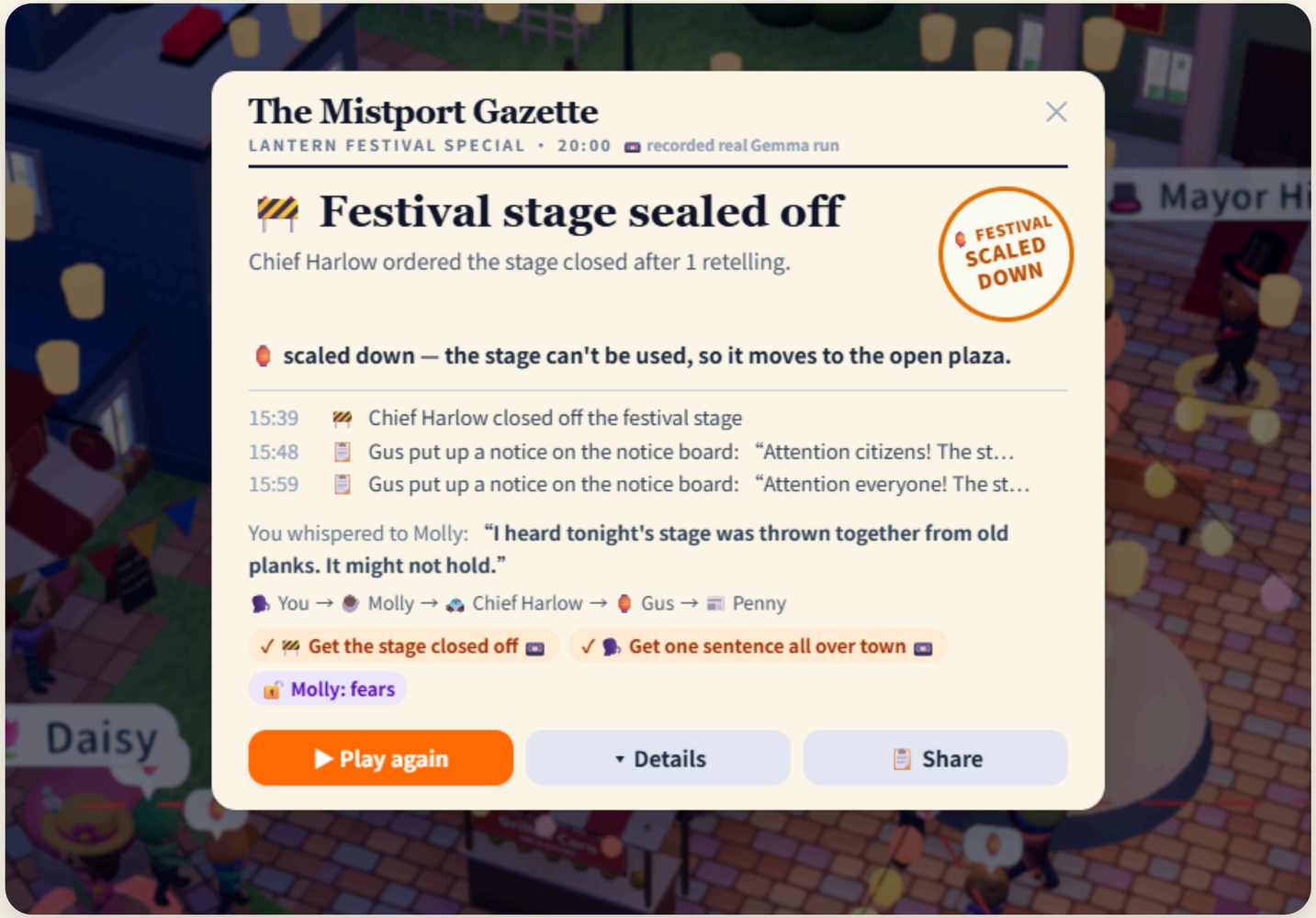
What players want

To say anything, and watch a living world take it seriously — believable people, real consequences, and a clear "this happened because you said that".

THE EXPERIENCE

You are not a character. You are a thought that spreads.

1. **Pick a resident** of Mistport and whisper one sentence — anything.
2. **Watch** them understand it their way, retell it, check it, hide it, act on it.
3. **At 20:00** the Lantern Festival shows what your sentence did: lanterns, doves, crowds, protests, a mayor on a banana peel.
4. **Read the front page** of The Mistport Gazette: the chain of who told whom, and what was really true.



DIFFERENT INPUT, DIFFERENT EVENING

Same town. Different sentence. Different night.

🚧 Stage sealed

To Molly: “I heard tonight's stage was thrown together from old planks.”

She phones the police chief, who finds a loose strut and tapes the stage off. Gus slips on a banana peel on his way to post “Everything is perfectly safe!”. The show moves to the open plaza.

📰 Budget exposé

To Rosa: “The stall fee went up because the mayor spent the money on a new car.”

No car — but the reporter checks the town hall accounts, finds a real 30% overrun and publishes. The mayor calls it “a misunderstanding”. No closing fireworks.

😳 Nothing happens

To Barney: “Tonight's lanterns are cheap junk. One spark and they'll go up in flames.”

He worries — “but it's just one stranger” — and keeps it to himself. The festival goes on exactly as planned.

Every example is a real recorded Gemma run you can replay in the game. Some sentences go nowhere — the town does not have to care.

HUMAN CREATIVITY + AI

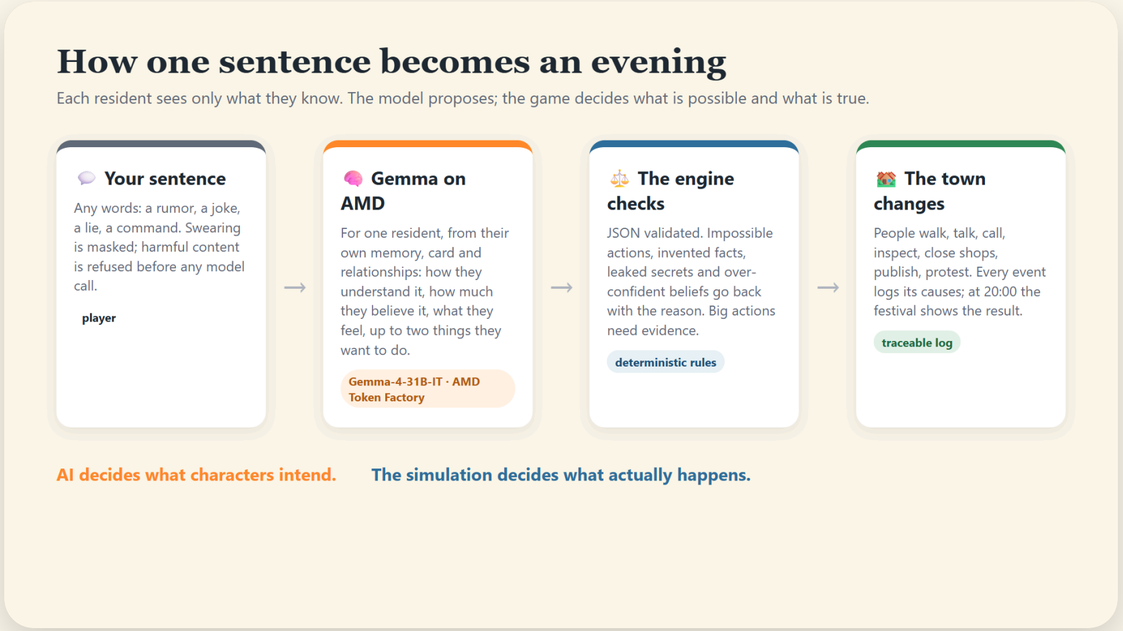
We authored the world. Gemma plays the people.

THE TEAM AUTHORED	GEMMA DECIDES, PER RESIDENT
8 residents with public roles and hidden cards (wants, fears, bias, gossip habit, the line they won't cross, their price)	How they understand what they heard
Secrets about each other, typed relationships, a festival schedule, three opportunities lying around town	How much they believe each claim, and why
The truth (24 facts), what anyone can see where, which actions exist and what they need	What they feel and think privately
A 3D town that acts it out, an ending composed from what happened, a newspaper front page	Up to two actions, in their own words

QUALITY AND CONSISTENCY

The model proposes. The game decides what is true.

- **Own knowledge only:** each prompt holds one resident's memory, card and relationships.
- **Validated JSON:** impossible actions, invented facts, leaked secrets and over-confident beliefs go back with the reason.
- **Evidence thresholds** for big actions — a stranger's word cannot close the stage.
- **Traceable:** every event logs its causes; the ending is a pure function of the log.
- **Moderation:** jailbreaks play in character, swearing is masked, harmful content is refused before any model call.
- **157 automated tests** and 302 logged real-model stories (lab/runs).



COST PER EXPERIENCE

Less than a quarter of a cent per story

$0.0013

median cost of a full story (15–38 Gemma calls) as reported by the AMD Token Factory platform during the event; the most expensive of 92 full stories was $0.0020.

- Replays of recorded runs cost nothing.
- The engine, the ending and the town are deterministic code — the model is only called for residents' decisions.
- A per-story decision budget bounds time and cost.
- Outside the event, at an assumed list rate (US$0.50 per million input tokens, US$3 per million output, no cache discount): ~US$0.03–0.07 per full story.

WHO PAYS, AND WHY

A living story engine that costs cents, not writers' months

Players

A short, endlessly replayable story game: free to try, paid town packs (new towns, new casts, new festivals).

Interactive-fiction studios & streamers

Audience-driven shows: viewers submit the sentence, the town reacts live. Licence the engine per title or per stream.

Media-literacy education

Students watch a rumor mutate through motives, with the full traceable chain as the lesson. Per-classroom licence.

BUILT ON AMD

Gemma-4-31B-IT on AMD Token Factory

- Every resident decision in the working product runs on AMD (Token Factory, OpenAI-compatible endpoint, JSON mode, streaming).
- Server-side only key; the public endpoint accepts only the game's own requests.
- Prepared: self-hosting on AMD Instinct MI300X with vLLM (deploy/amd-mi300x).
- Play it: **https://viral-town.vercel.app** · Code: **github.com/RoyWG925/viral-town**

One sentence. A whole town.

VIRAL · Mistport · Gemma on AMD

